

I've been interested in SQL for a while, so I decided to clean a global layoffs dataset as an opportunity to grow my skills.

The raw dataset contained double nulls, incorrect categorizations, duplicates, and spelling errors. This reminded me of the disorganized datasets I had encountered while gaining experience with businesses of different sizes.

Through those experiences, I realized how messy data can make bookkeeping, investment analysis, and forecasting much more difficult. Even small inconsistencies can make it harder to understand what the numbers are actually telling you. So, I took this as an opportunity to experiment with SQL.

The project was definitely tricky, especially while learning new functions alongside the coding process. I found dealing with duplicates and null values particularly challenging. Catching every small inconsistency — sometimes down to a single letter or value — was an adjustment.

Through functions like `ROW_NUMBER`, CTEs, `TRIM`, `LIKE`, `STR_TO_DATE`, and `JOINS`, I identified duplicates, standardized inconsistent entries, converted date formats, and addressed missing values.

Nevertheless, it was a pretty straightforward project and gave me a better understanding of processing data for more streamlined analyses. I will definitely be building more!